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What's Going On

Looking at the Quantum World

Albert Einstein, who had a way with words as well as with equations, was the one who stuck quantum mechanics with the label it has been unable to shake ever since: *spukhaft*, usually translated from German to English as "spooky." If nothing else, that's the impression we get from most public discussions of quantum mechanics. We're told that it's a part of physics that is unavoidably mystifying, weird, bizarre, unknowable, strange, baffling. Spooky.

Inscrutability can be alluring. Like a mysterious, sexy stranger, quantum mechanics tempts us into projecting all sorts of qualities and capacities onto it, whether they are there or not. A brief search for books with "quantum" in the title reveals the following list of purported applications:

Quantum Success
Quantum Leadership
Quantum Consciousness
Quantum Touch
Quantum Yoga
Quantum Eating
Quantum Psychology
Quantum Mind
Quantum Glory
Quantum Forgiveness
Quantum Theology